



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	28 May 2024	Time of Incident	11.15am
Directorate / Region	RMO – Metropolitan	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Near Miss	EQSafe Incident Number	40675
Actual Consequence	Minor	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Excavator operator struck an unidentified overhead powerline
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Executive Summary

At approximately 11:15am, whilst an excavator operator was moving soil, the boom of the excavator operated by a subcontractor operator has struck an unidentified overhead powerline at the construction site.

The excavator operator immediately stopped all operations, and the area surrounding the incident was evacuated to ensure the safety of all personnel.

The site manager contacted the local power utility company to report the incident, and they dispatched experienced personnel to inspect the affected line. It was then confirmed the powerline was low voltage, and the powerline had not been identified in the Before You Dig (BYDA) plans.

Incident Photos**Incident site****Contributing Factors**

- The powerline was not accurately identified in the BYDA plans provided for site. This incomplete mapping data led to a complete lack of awareness of the powerline's presence.
- The excavator operator was new to the site, and there was inadequate supervision provided to ensure they were aware of the site-specific hazards.
- The overhead powerline was not adequately marked, identified with visible signage, or had physical barriers, which contributed to it blending in with the surroundings.

Corrective Actions

- Collaborate closely with utility companies to ensure BYDA plans are accurate and up to date prior to commencement of works.
- Conduct comprehensive and thorough site surveys to identify all utilities, ensuring they are all identified and highly visible.
- Ensure new site personnel, especially those operating heavy machinery, receive adequate supervision and orientation. This includes ensuring they are aware of all site specific hazards.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- Implement proactive risk management strategies with crews, such as hazard assessment and pre-task planning, to identify and mitigate potential risks related to utilities.

**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to
Service Strike (Above Ground)

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations